It is obvious that the two occurrences, the pinprick and the sensation of pain, can be examined and analyzed most thoroughly, in every detail. But such an analysis calls for two different methods, which mutually preclude each other. Each of the two corresponds to one of two different viewpoints. In the following I will refer to them, respectively, as the *psychological* and the *physiological* viewpoints. Observation based on the psychological viewpoint is rooted in self-consciousness; therefore, it is applicable directly only to the analysis of one's own mental processes. On the other hand, observation based on the physiological viewpoint is directed at the processes in the external world; therefore, its direct scope is limited to physical processes. These two viewpoints are incompatible. The adoption of one when the other one is called for, always leads to confusion. We cannot judge our mental processes directly from the physiological viewpoint any more than we can examine a physical process from the psychological viewpoint. This state of affairs makes the body-mind problem appear in a different light. For the examination of psychosomatic processes will yield entirely different results, according as the psychological or the physiological viewpoint is taken as the basis of observation. The psychological viewpoint will permit us to gain first-hand knowledge solely and exclusively of something that relates to our mental processes. The physiological viewpoint will produce first-hand information about physical processes only. It is therefore impossible to gain first-hand information about both physical and mental processes from any single viewpoint; and since in order to reach a clear conclusion, we must adhere to a given viewpoint, which automatically excludes the other, the search for the interrelation of physical and mental processes loses its meaning. In this case, there exist only physical processes *or* mental processes, but never processes which are physical *and* mental.

Therefore, it will do no harm to say that the physical and the mental are in no way different from each other. They are the selfsame processes, only viewed from two diametrically opposite directions. This statement is the answer to the riddle, which has been inseparable from the theory of parallelism, namely, how one is to conceive the fact that two types of processes so different from each other as the physical and the mental, are so closely interlinked. The link has now been disclosed. At the same time, the body-mind problem has been recognized as another phantom problem.

III.

The cases heretofore discussed have dealt only with knowledge, and feeling. Physical states and processes are known, mental states and processes are felt. The situation is quite different, and more complicated, when